

4 Mobile platforms

“Those parts of the system that you can hit with a hammer (not advised) are called hardware; those program instructions that you can only curse at are called software.”

Now that we have decent idea as to what hardware features will suit your requirements, it is equally if not more important to select a right software platform for you. There are a lot of software platforms available in the market and an exhaustive overview of each is not possible given the practical constraints. We have picked up the following platforms based on the popularity and significance in the current market scenario.

Symbian Series 40

Omnipresent in nearly all low-end to mid-range Nokia phones. The interface has inspired host of other similar platforms and 3x4 or a 3x3 menu grid found in some of the proprietary interfaces of Sony and LG (low-end to mid-end phones) resemble Series 40 in function, feature and organisation.

Symbian Series 60 with Touch enabled 5th Edition

This was nearly the first real smartphone OS from the house of symbian and is reputed to be one of the most mature ones at that. Nearly the de-facto choice for all Nokia business phones. The latest generation, Series 60 5th Edition, has made it touch screen device ready and has found its way into major handsets such as Samsung Omnia HD, N97 and 5800 XpressMusic.

TouchWiz by Samsung

Samsung with its latest generation of touch screen is eating into the market share of nearly all manufactures. While researching to select the interfaces, we were blown away by the user friendliness of this interface. The best part is that it can also be implemented partly over and above an existing one as in the case of Samsung OmniaHD which runs a Series 60 5th Edition, but comes with the TouchWiz interface to jazz up the home Screen.

Windows Mobile

In any software segment it is hard to omit Microsoft as company. Their version for a mobile device mimics the functionality and use of its desktop counterpart. Also it makes your mobile device compatible with ease with exchange server in the corporate environment. Also in our testing it was the most configurable platform with enough customisation to please anyone and everyone. Plugins such as HTC's TouchFLO and Sony's XPanel interface further enhance the ease of use.

If you have started complaining already about us missing the iPhone OS and